

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

W E D N E S D A Y , A P R I L 1 6 , 2 0 2 5

‘Borrowing money is not a sign of weakness, but a sign of strength.’

LARRY LADD, *a former budget officer at Harvard*

Their funding at stake, colleges look to borrow

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Even before the Trump administration on Monday froze \$2.2 billion in federal funding for Harvard University, the Cambridge institution had taken a significant precautionary step to bolster its coffers: Wall Street.

The school last week issued \$750 million in bonds, money it would put toward “general corporate purposes,” a spokesper-

son said, as part of “ongoing contingency planning for a range of financial circumstances.”

And while Harvard’s “circumstances” at the moment may be higher-profile than most, it is among a number of universities that are stepping up their short-term borrowing during a tenuous time for higher education.

Institutions routinely tap tax-

FINANCES, Page A9

Pushing back

A federal judge said she will order sworn testimony by Trump officials to determine if they complied with her orders on Kilmar Abrego Garcia. **A7.**

Stop work

A top scientist at Harvard has been told to halt her tuberculosis research by the federal government. **B1.**

School’s tax-exempt status threatened; hospitals will be spared worst of cuts

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

As Harvard University prepares for a titanic showdown with the Trump administration over its academic independence, the president on Tuesday threatened the school’s tax-exempt status while the first effects of a \$2 billion freeze in federal funding began to be felt on campus.

The university has yet to file a legal challenge opposing the government’s crushing punishment for refusing the administration’s demands to implement extraordinary policy changes and submit to federal oversight. But lawyers and higher education leaders said Tuesday that the fight is virtually certain to end up in court.

On Tuesday the Trump ad-

ministration ratcheted up pressure. President Trump suggested the university’s tax-exempt status could be revoked, while White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt said the president wanted an apology for what she called “egregious anti-semitism” on Harvard’s campus.

Meanwhile, research hospitals affiliated with Harvard, such as Mass General Brigham and Boston Children’s Hospital — world-leading institutions in

HARVARD, Page A9



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Deborah Dailey went on maternity leave when her son, Nathien, was born. She had been planning to return to work but needs a voucher.

Without vouchers, a crushing wait

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

It’s been almost two years since Hannah Tower applied for a child-care subsidy for her youngest son, Cooper, now almost 3. Tower, a single mother in Dudley, had just finished training to become a certified phlebotomist and EKG tech, and was ready to find a job.

But vouchers for families like hers, who qualify based on their income, have been frozen for a year. And without that financial assistance, Tower can’t send Cooper to day care, which means that Tower, 34, can’t work.

Massachusetts is providing financial assistance to more children than ever — 63,000 in all — but

Because the need is so great, Mass. has frozen child-care subsidies, leaving families on hold

the need is so great that the number of families applying for vouchers is soaring. Nearly 32,000 children are on the wait list, and it’s unclear when there will be enough state funding to start issuing new vouchers again.

Some families, including those involved with the Department of Children and Families or the

Department of Transitional Assistance, are still receiving aid, as required by state law. But for parents like Tower, the wait list is daunting.

“I’m looking at, if I don’t get that voucher, waiting until my son goes to school, which makes me broke for another couple years,” said Tower, who will have to continue relying on rental assistance, food banks, toy drives, and other social safety nets to get by until she can work. “It’s almost impossible to get out of this low-income hole.”

The demand for subsidies is partly due to an unprecedented increase in DCF and DTA cases as the rising cost of living pushes more families to

VOUCHERS, Page A6

Database helps ICE target students

Colleges now watch closely for ‘terminations’

By Brooke Hauser
and Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

At first it was just a handful of students with some connection to pro-Palestinian activity, then dozens more, many of whom had no link to the protest movement. Now the Trump administration has abruptly terminated the legal status of nearly 5,000 international students and scholars across the country, according to the American Immigration Lawyers Association, setting off waves of fear on campuses around the country.

A good number of students are from China, India, South Korea, Saudi Arabia, and Nigeria, though they also represent countries like Egypt, Mexico, Turkey, and Jamaica. They’re studying everything from computer science and engineering to child and human development. And they now find themselves in a terrifying limbo — in the United States without the permission of the federal government and at risk of arrest, detention, and deportation.

Many of the students have no idea why they’ve been targeted for “termination” — the official Immigration and Customs Enforcement designation. Was it a protest or political op-ed that sent up a red flag? An old speeding ticket or social media post picked up by a bot?

Higher education institutions, lawyers, and student advocacy groups are also in the

VISAS, Page A8

No sign of thaw in Boston-area housing market

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

People like Graham Boylan and his partner are supposed to be able to settle in Boston.

They’re both engineers. They make six-figure salaries, and Boylan works for a prominent technology company. And yet, every time they have searched for a home to buy over the past several years, they have come up empty-handed.

Their first and biggest hurdle is the region’s crushing house prices, which would see them pay \$1 million for a small condominium in or around Cambridge, where they’d like to live. Then there are interest rates, which at current levels would add thousands of dollars a month to their housing costs. And the fact is, there are very few places even available to buy right now. The homes they have toured always seem to be missing a non-negotiable feature, like accessible laundry.

All of that together has brought them to an

HOUSING, Page A6

A SOMBER REMEMBRANCE



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Twelve years after the Marathon bombing, families of the victims marked One Boston Day by walking to the memorial sites on Boylston Street for wreath ceremonies. They were joined Tuesday by Mayor Michelle Wu and Lieutenant Governor Kim Driscoll. **B2.**



50s-50s chance

Wednesday: Windy, cooler. High 49-54. Low 37-42.

Thursday: A bit warmer. High 54-59. Low 36-41.

Sunrise: 6:01 Sunset: 7:27

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C11.

For breaking news, updated stories, and more, visit our website:

BostonGlobe.com

VOL. 307, NO. 106

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00



The state’s spending plans are up in the air as lawmakers cope with President Trump’s whims. **B1.**

Tens of thousands of people have fled attacks on camps for displaced families in Sudan, the United Nations’ migration agency said. **A3.**

Yvonne Hao, Massachusetts’ economic development secretary, is leaving the Healey administration to spend more time with family. **B5.**

Harvey Weinstein was back in a Manhattan court for the start of a new trial. **A2.**

The Celtics now know their opponent in the first round of the playoffs — the Orlando Magic. **C1.**

Where other restaurant concepts sputter in Boston, Italian generally succeeds. Devra First knows why. **G1.**